Step	Deals
Completed deals, 1990–2019 (pre-COVID), duplicates removed	928,481
(−) Intra-group transactions (same ultimate parent)	(67,237)
(−) Targets in regulated industries (financials, utilities, transportation)	(178,191)
(−) Targets without Compustat financials	(622,393)
(−) Implausible accounting values	(1,846)
Final sample	**58,814**